

A New Era

The period between 1977 and 1983 is regarded as the second generation of video game consoles. The games on cartridges started being sold during the mid-1970s, in which game code was written on the microchips using discrete logic. These ROM microchips were packed in a plastic cartridge casing which would fit the console slot size. Out of many, three video game consoles dominated the second generation video game consoles—the Atari 2600 (1977), Intellivision (1980), and the Colecovision (1982).

The Atari Video Computer System was released as a cartridge-based console, and it was later renamed the Atari 2600. Intellivision from Mattel is part of the 8-bit era, having a unique processor that allowed a variety of instructions sets for a potential gain in speed. In addition, its graphics were considered superior to that of the Atari 2600. The Colecovision, introduced in 1982, was a powerful console whose sales took off initially but couldn't last long in the face of the competition.

Database Management System was based on the IBM System/R model, and in 1979, the first database management system (SQL RDBMS) was developed using IBM's SQL programming language.

The name "Oracle" came from the database engine which was being developed for a consulting project (code-named Oracle) with the US CIA. Ellison and Miner worked on the project where the CIA wanted them to use the new SQL language. Oracle is regarded the world's largest RDBMS vendor, which also develops tools for database development, enterprise resource planning (ERP) software, Customer relationship development software (CRM), and supply chain management software (SCM).

Enter the PC Modem: Hayes Again

The PC modem was invented by Dennis Hayes and Dale Heatherington. It was a communication-enabling device used to convert one form of signal to another for smooth transmission, that is, converting signals from digital to analogue and then from analogue to digital. Both Hayes and Heatherington market-